Robert Heideman

Bicycle Technician | Workshop Lead | Skills Mentor

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PROFILE

I've been riding bikes since I was two, and at 14 I landed my first job building bikes at my local bike shop over the summer holidays. I've worked as a mechanic ever since, from the end of high school and all through university. When I started my career as a Prosthetist-Orthotist, I kept the bikes going, working on my own and travelling as a tour mechanic with Wide Open Road Cycling in Europe, Japan and Australia. In 2020, during COVID, I started my own bike brand, Heiden Cycle Works, designing and building custom bespoke bikes myself. I've also created and adapted bikes for people with disabilities. What I enjoy most is passing on what I know, and I'd love to bring that to PUSH!, helping young people build their own bikes and the confidence that comes with it.

KEY SKILLS

- **Bicycle mechanics:** full servicing, diagnosis and repair of road, mountain, hybrid, kids' and e-bikes; complete bike builds from the frame up, including custom frame building; brakes, gears, drivetrains, wheels, hubs and bearings.
- **Adaptive bikes:** creating and adapting bikes for people with disabilities, drawing on my orthotics background.
- **Safety checks and refurbishment:** inspecting and refurbishing second-hand bikes so they're safe and roadworthy, and making the most of donated and recycled parts.
- **Workshop management:** running workshops, including tool and equipment upkeep, parts inventory and ordering, workflow and workplace safety.
- **Teaching and mentoring:** mentoring junior and new technicians, and breaking complex tasks into simple, achievable steps. I'm patient, encouraging and good at building confidence.
- **Making and fabrication:** carbon frame building, design and problem-solving, including Fusion 360 CAD and 3D printing (FDM, SLA, SLS). I love inventing, building and improving things.

BICYCLE INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Founder / Frame Builder and Bicycle Technician 2020 – Present

Heiden Cycle Works, Brisbane QLD

- Founded the business. I design and build custom bicycle frames from carbon tubes joined with 3D-printed lugs, which I design myself.
- Build, service and repair all kinds of bikes, from entry-level commuters to high-end race bikes.
- Diagnose faults, quote the work and complete repairs to a high safety standard.
- Run every part of the business, including customer service, sourcing and ordering parts, workshop and tool upkeep, and accounts.

Travelling Tour Mechanic 2016 – Present (tours each year)

Wide Open Road Cycling

- Travel with multi-day cycling tours in Europe, Japan and Australia each year and maintain every bike on the tour.
- Do daily safety checks, servicing and roadside repairs from a mobile workshop, often with limited tools and parts.
- Friendly, helpful point of contact for riders of all abilities, keeping them safe and riding.

Bicycle Mechanic 2009 – 2015

The Ride Cycles, Kew VIC

- Workshop mechanic in a busy retail bike shop: servicing, repairs, new bike builds and customer service.

Volunteer Mechanic – Great Victorian Bike Ride 2008 – 2015

Warrandyte High School, VIC

- Registered mechanic for the school's student team over eight years, keeping students' bikes running on a multi-day ride.
- Worked alongside students and teachers, keeping young riders safe and on the road.

Volunteer Mechanic and Support Crew – Lesa Ashford 2023

Solo world-record attempt: first and fastest woman to cycle around Australia

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE – PROSTHETICS AND ORTHOTICS

Ten years as a Prosthetist-Orthotist and technician in Australia, Sweden and Norway, building custom devices by hand.

Sole Owner / Principal Orthotist Oct 2026 – Present
Roam Orthotics

Senior Orthotist Jan 2026 – Sep 2026
Ability Made

- Senior orthotic role delivering custom orthoses made with digital scanning and design.

Senior Prosthetist/Orthotist May 2025 – Mar 2026
Princess Alexandra Hospital, Woolloongabba QLD

- Manage complex inpatient and outpatient cases as part of a multidisciplinary team, and lead quality assurance projects.

Senior Orthotic Technician and Head of Digital Design Jan 2024 – Present
Queensland Orthotic Lab, Capalaba QLD

- Hands-on fabrication in a busy production workshop. I mentor and train junior and new technicians.
- Introduced 3D scanning, modelling and printing into the lab's manufacturing process.

Senior Clinical Orthotist and Technician Oct 2018 – Mar 2023
Orthotic Motion Pty Ltd, Geelong VIC

Prosthetist-Orthotist and Technician Aug 2017 – Aug 2018
Drevelin Ortopedi AB, Bergen, Norway

Prosthetist-Orthotist and Technician Feb 2016 – Aug 2017
Optopedia Ortopediteknisk AS, Stockholm, Sweden

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Bachelor of Health Science / Master of Clinical Prosthetics and Orthotics 2012 – 2015
La Trobe University, Bundoora VIC

Cultural Exchange Program Jan 2014 – Jul 2014
Jönköping University, Sweden

- **Professional development:** founding member of the Digital Limb Collective; participant at the 2016 ISPO European Congress.

COMMUNITY AND VOLUNTEERING

- Veterans International Cambodia, Phnom Penh (2015): volunteered building and fitting low-cost prostheses with limited resources.
- Regular volunteer at Edgar's Mission animal sanctuary, Lancefield VIC.
- Oxfam Trailwalker, Taupō NZ (2013): our team raised $15,000.
- Relay For Life participant (2009–2012); Australian Red Cross door-knock appeal volunteer (2009–2013).

OTHER INFORMATION

- **Screening checks:** current Queensland Blue Card (held a Working with Children Check for 10+ years) and current NDIS Worker Screening Check (Yellow Card).
- **Languages:** English (native), Swedish and Norwegian (proficient).
- **Computer skills:** Microsoft Word, Excel, Outlook and PowerPoint; Fusion 360; HTML and CSS.
- **Interests:** road, mountain, track and triathlon cycling. I've completed Ironman Melbourne, the 3 Peaks Challenge and the Otway Odyssey. I also enjoy surfing, skiing and camping.

REFERENCES

Clare Holdsworth
Owner and Tour Operator, Wide Open Road Cycle Tours
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Liz Heagney
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